

NEW LIBERAL CLUB (NLC) J6:76
KONO, REPRESENTATIVE

1. Tax Increase

The current demand for administrative expenditures is not appropriate; the inefficient administrative structure has ballooned in size and eats up a huge amount of money. Much of the almost 13 trillion yen given in subsidies is wasted. The administration, therefore, needs to be reformed and the subsidies reorganized. In addition, we cannot permit taxes to be raised so easily when dietmen have not set an appropriate example to the country by carrying out drastic reforms such as reducing the number of dietmen.

A general consumption tax which the government proposes to establish is a bad tax. It will raise prices, put a large burden on low income earners, cheat tax payers, raise the number of tax workers, and complicate the work of supermarkets and grocery shops.

2. Inflation and Energy

The road to overcoming the energy crisis involves the following: 1) vigorous research and development of alternate energy sources, 2) exhaustive energy conservation, 3) securing stable supplies of oil, 4) the establishment of a transportation system that strives to make efficient the movement of people and goods, and 5) industrial reconversion. In any case, we must work out a comprehensive policy that from a middle to long term

perspective. Increases in oil prices will immediately cause inflation.

We must take cooperative steps with consumer countries in confronting the various OPEC nations and promote negotiations that will reconcile the interests of both consumers and producers. In particular, our country must display leadership in promoting such negotiations. At the same time, in order to prevent the shock of price increases, we must strive to diversify the sources from which we buy crude oil. We must strongly push forward with the above five measures; it is of vital importance that we change quickly the situation where 77 percent of our country's energy consumption relies on crude oil.

3. Correction of Political Corruption

First of all, it is necessary to reform the system to make it difficult for political corruption to occur. In order to do this, we will have the National Treasury provide part of the political funds of the political parties, promote much more the public management of elections, make it an obligation to make a complete public disclosure of the earnings and expenditures of political funds, as well as enacting laws regarding political parties, regulating political funds, and revising the public office election law.

In addition, we will investigate the possibility of enacting a public information law that will strengthen and set up standardized regulations regarding the authority of the Diet to

conduct investigations. Secondly, in order to establish political ethics, politicians must disclose their assets, and we must establish an independent organ to investigate acts of political corruption and strengthen the maintenance of penalties, laws, and regulations.

4. Welfare and Expenditures

To prevent misappropriations, beneficiaries must take up part of the burden.

By unifying the various types of medical insurance into one system, we will rationalize fees and benefits and strive to pool together revenues. We will promote the enforcement of the 65 year old retirement age and revise the complex pension system. We will unify the currently disparate public pension system so that it gives a fixed amount and equal benefits for all people.

5. Diplomacy and Defense

It is necessary to establish a collective security system centered on the Japan-U.S. Security Treaty and bear a share of the responsibility befitting our national strength. We must stress that outlays to the Self-Defense Forces be efficient. And with regard to the scope of the expenditures, a standing national defense committee should be established in the Diet in which the issue should be deliberated and settled.

At the same time, we must develop a variegated peace diplomacy to secure stability in our supply of energy, natural resources, and food.

6. Education

We must reduce the number of subjects on the standard first round university entrance examination and delay the enforcement time period, plus expand the latitude of choice in the subjects to be tested. The number of academic subjects to be tested in the second round test should be limited to just one, with the main criteria for the evaluation based on an essay and interview covering the one subject area.

There is no alternative except to wait for good sense to come to universities regarding back door entrance to schools. But for schools that have been found to be admitting students through the back door, we will take severe measures such as substantially reducing their subsidies.

SOCIAL DEMOCRATIC LEAGUE (SDL) DEN, REPRESENTATIVE

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1. Tax Increase

1) We will carry out bold administrative reforms that will simplify administrative structures, abolish the subsidy system, and transfer the regional transfer funds to reduce expenditures. 2) We will reduce the burden on finances by rational reform of the Japanese National Railway, food control system, and health insurance system. 3) We will raise tax revenues by correcting the favorable tax treatment given to doctors and other unfair aspects of the tax system.

If the above measure are carried out, there will be no need